Gabrielle Sorresso

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Education

PhD, Public Policy, Cornell University 2022–Present
Concentration in Economics
MA, Public Policy

BA, Economics & Environmental Studies, Colgate University 2018–2022
summa cum laude
High Honors in Economics

Research Interests

Health Economics, Maternal and Child Health, Reproductive Policy, Environmental Health, Gender

Research

Peer Reviewed Publications

Sassler, Sharon, and **Gabrielle Sorresso**. 2026. Narrowing the Gender Wage Gap among Computer Science Professionals: What Differentiates the Earnings of Asian and White Workers? *RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences*, 12(3): 98–123.

Working Papers

It Was Already Dobbs: Abortion Bans and Maternal Health

Supported by a grant from the Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy

Clinicians, medical societies, and journalists warned that abortion bans enabled by the *Dobbs v. Jackson* decision would harm maternal health by delaying the treatment of miscarriage and other complications, ending access to terminations for medical reasons, and driving out obstetricians. However, the states that banned abortion after *Dobbs* had already restricted the procedure for over a decade through a variety of regulations and laws. To test the effect of the *Dobbs*-enabled bans on a range of pregnancy-related outcomes, I use detailed health insurance claims covering nearly 1 million pregnancies from conception through postpartum. My empirical design compares pregnancies in states that banned abortion with those in states that did not in a stacked difference-in-differences design. I find minimal evidence that the bans significantly or meaningfully changed maternal health outcomes at the population level. For example, bans did not significantly change the rate of adverse pregnancy outcomes, such as infection, preterm birth, and gestational diabetes, and the 95 percent confidence interval rules out increases larger than 7.1 percent. Additional results for maternal health are also null and generally precise, as are the

estimated effects on the timing and intensity of care. The effects do not appear to be driven by any particular subgroup, and the results are robust to a variety of samples and specifications. Turning to the channels through which the bans could act, while I find suggestive evidence that fertility rates rose modestly after the bans, the composition of the pregnant population, including its pre-pregnancy health, remains largely unchanged. Additionally, OB-GYNs stayed in practice and continued providing routine obstetric care. These results imply that restoring the federal right to abortion alone may not meaningfully change the maternal health and care landscape for women.

First Do No Harm: The Labor Market Consequences of a Physician Disciplinary Record (Joint with Amanda Agan and Colleen Carey)

Using a novel dataset of 70,000 state medical board disciplinary actions across more than 40 states (2008–2023), we provide the first evidence on how State Medical Board discipline affects subsequent physician careers. Most disciplined physicians continue practicing—often in a new state and supplying fewer claims—evidence that can inform the optimal design of state oversight and disciplinary actions.

Hard to Concentrate: Prenatal Air Pollution and Childhood ADHD

Using medical claims for millions of children and Clean Air Act nonattainment designations that required states to reduce fine particulate pollution, I study whether exposure before birth raises the probability of an ADHD diagnosis later in childhood. Preliminary evidence shows that higher county air pollution is associated with more visits for ADHD, anxiety, and depression among children in the same year.

Inequality Within the Family or Within Professions? The Role of Assortative Mating in Shaping the Gender Wage Gap Among Power Couples (Joint with Sharon Sassler)

Born After Dobbs: Abortion Bans, Prenatal Diagnosis,
and the Prevalence of Congenital Conditions

Abortion bans may change which pregnancies continue after a serious prenatal diagnosis. I test whether bans raised the prevalence at birth of conditions usually detected during pregnancy, such as Down syndrome, relative to conditions that cannot be detected before birth, and follow affected infants through their first year of care.

Conference Presentations

Southern Economic Association (SEA) — Scheduled, November 2026

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) — November 2025

Teaching Experience

Cornell University

PUBPOL 2210: Poverty and Public Policy
Course Administrator for Maureen Waller — Spring 2026

PUBPOL 2030: Population and Demography
Teaching Assistant for Sharon Sassler — Spring 2024

PADM 5310: Applied Multivariate Statistics in Public Affairs
Teaching Assistant for Doug Miller — Fall 2023

Colgate University

ECON 375: Introduction to Econometrics
Teaching Assistant for Carolina Castilla — Fall 2021 & Spring 2022

Awards and Fellowships

Irving Louis Horowitz Award for Most Outstanding Project ($15,000) — 2026
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Cornell Brooks School — Spring 2024
Exemplary Service Award, Cornell Brooks School — 2023–2024
Sage Fellow, Cornell University — 2022–Present
Award for Outstanding Work in Economics, Colgate University — 2022

Professional Service

Cornell University

Gender Equality Representative, Diversity in Cornell Economics — 2022–2025
Executive Board Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics — 2025–Present
Student Host (twice), Cornell Population Center Speaker Series — 2026
President, PhD Student Organization — 2024
Mentor, First Year PhD Mentor Program — 2023, 2025

Colgate University

Mentor, Women in Economics — 2021–2022

Professional Associations

American Society of Health Economists
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management
Cornell Population Center
Cornell Health Policy Center

Skills and Certifications

Programming: Stata (advanced), Python (advanced), SQL (advanced), R (basic), Matlab (basic), LaTeX
Certifications: CITI (valid until 2030)
Citizenship: USA

References

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